FINC 4331 – Business Finance
University of Houston-Clear Lake
Fall 2023 Syllabus

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Zoom Hours: Mon. 11 am to 12 pm & 7 pm to 8 pm
F2F Hours: Wed. 5:30 pm to 6:30 pm
Other times by appointment

Hyperlinks to Syllabus Sections

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EXPECTATIONS

The syllabus contains the policies and expectations for the course. These policies and expectations are the foundation for creating a productive learning environment for everyone. As a student, you share the responsibility for creating a positive atmosphere where learning thrives by behaving courteously and respectfully toward your peers and professor and becoming self-disciplined in your learning. The expectations about behaviors and attitudes that will make you a successful student will translate well to the workplace.

You are expected to:

- Participate in all face-to-face sessions and live online sessions, if any.

- Be punctual to class and do not leave/disconnect early.
- Portray a respectful demeanor and refrain from other tasks during our class to avoid being disruptive to your peers and professor.
- Listen respectfully. Comments that you make should reflect that you have been actively listening.
- **Ask for clarifications when class material or discussions are unclear.**
- **Understand that making mistakes is part of the learning process. Some concepts are simple. Others are more complex. Learn from your mistakes and the mistakes of others.**

- Take group work seriously. Collaborate with your peers in problem-solving. Remember that your peer's learning is partly dependent on your participation.
- Be aware of how much you are contributing to group work and class discussions. Promoting a strong collaborative environment requires involvement from all group members. Contribute and know when to step back to let others participate.
- Complete work timely by being aware of due dates as indicated in the syllabus.
- Check your email and Canvas announcements at least once every two business days.

What you can expect from me is to:

- Always maintain a civil environment.
- Begin and end class on time.
- Return papers and exams in a timely fashion.
- Arrive for each class prepared.
- Treat students with respect.
- Always behave professionally.

ATTENDANCE & ENGAGEMENT

Class attendance is expected. Success in this course is dependent on your active participation and engagement throughout the semester. **Should you be unable to attend class, you are still responsible for all course material and announcements made. No more than two face-to-face classes can be missed during the semester. This excludes the case group discussion class when all students are required to be in attendance.** Two classes during the semester will be delivered completely online via recorded lecture through Canvas. Please refer to the Class Schedule and Due Dates for the topics delivered online.

Active participation in class discussions is an important part of learning in this course. I encourage you to cue me or a guest speaker when you would like to respond to a question or prompt, or when you have a question. I also expect each of you to be prepared for our sessions and ready to respond to questions or prompts even if you do not volunteer to do so. **High-quality participation means that you are prepared for our sessions, not that you always have the correct response.** Hearing responses from everyone in the class allows us to gain new perspectives and consider questions that we may not have thought of, and at times helps me understand that there is confusion and offers me the opportunity to respond to that confusion. Your active participation and engagement is expected. You will notice that when I ask a question, I will pause for about 10 seconds before calling on someone. This is intentional. These few seconds will allow you to think about the question, promoting thoughtful and thorough responses.

You can earn up to a half-a-letter grade added to your final grade for your participation. The bonus participation grade will include:

- **Your participation when called upon.**
- **Your participation in any bonus activities available.**
- **Your engagement with the guest lecturer.**
- **Your participation in polling, if used.**
- **Your participation in other activities that may arise during the semester.**

You will be assigned to a group, which will work together through the semester during breakout sessions, as well as on the case project.

ASSITANCE & COMMUNICATION

Connection Hours

I am available outside of class time to connect with you to dialog, not only about class material, but also to discuss careers in finance, graduate school, and other matters of importance to you to be successful in the course and to achieve your long-term career goals. Our one-on-one or group meetings will be via Zoom or in person as indicated at the beginning of the syllabus.

Communication

Although we will be meeting once a week, I may still need to communicate valuable information to you outside of class, and you will have questions for me. You can contact me via e-mail, and I may respond via a Canvas announcement if my response to your inquiry is something that all students should be aware of. I usually check my e-mail at least once every business day. Similarly, I expect you to check your e-mail and the Canvas announcements at least once every two-business day. **Please reach out to me via e-mail at bendeck@uhcl.edu or by phone at (281) 283 3221 if you have questions that are personal in nature.**

Getting Help

At some point during the semester, you may need some help to figure out a particularly challenging problem. I am available during connection hours for individualized help or via email.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Upon successful completion of this course, you will be able to:

- **Understand and apply the analytical framework for getting to know a bank's customer needs.**
- **Understand and apply the quantitative aspects of credit risk analysis using financial statements.**
- **Analyze cash flows to identify the borrowing causes and sources of repayment and calculate the impact of company fundamentals and swing factors on cash flows.**
- **Identify and apply the steps followed to build cash flow projections and assess results.**
- **Understand the keys to loan structure.**
- **Understand the basic role of a loan committee and their use of presentation packets.**
- **Identify the framework for evaluating an individual's financial wherewithal as guarantor for business loans through the evaluation of liquidity and quality of assets.**
- **Understand how business tax returns can be used as a source to identify cash flows and the quality of earnings.**
- **Understand the concept of global cash flows for small business and construct and analyze a global cash flow statement.**
- **Identify the loan documentation requirements for diverse types of business entities.**

PREREQUISITES AND CLASS MATERIAL

Prerequisites

The prerequisite for this class is FINC 3331 – Business Finance with a grade of "C" or better. Anyone who has not completed the required prerequisite courses should speak with me before continuing the course.

Course Materials

Textbook: Credit Essentials Course Participant Workbook, 2023, Risk Management Association.

The course material was designed by the Risk Management Association (RMA) Academic Foundation to familiarize students with the elements of commercial credit risk analysis. **Students will have the opportunity of earning the RMA's Credit Essentials Certificate upon completion of the course. Purchase of a textbook is not required. All course materials are provided free of charge by the RMA.**

Course material and cases are accessible through Canvas on a weekly basis. This includes the pdf. of the slide deck used in class discussions.

GRADING AND ITS COMPONENTS

Your performance in this course will be evaluated as follows:

Grading Components and Percentages

Category	Chapters Covered	Percent of Overall Grade
Online Chapter Quizzes	1, 2, 3 & 3A, 5, 6 & 6A, 7, 8, 8A, 9	40%
Comprehensive Final Exam*	All Chapters	20%
Individual Case Assignments & RMA mini - course topics	1, 2, 3 & 3A, 5, 8, 8A, 9 RMA - Business of Commercial Banking and Ethics and Decision Making	20%
Group Work		20%
Total		100%

***The comprehensive exam is the Credit Essential Certificate Exam. Students earning a minimum of 80% on the exam will earn the certificate.**

The following scale will be used to determine your final course grade:

Final Course Grades

% Of Total Points	Grade	% Of Total Points	Grade
92.0 - 100.0	A	72.0 - 77.9	C
90.0 - 91.9	A-	70.0 - 71.9	C-
88.0 - 89.9	B+	68.0 - 69.9	D+
82.0 - 87.9	B	62.0 - 67.9	D
80.0 - 81.9	B-	60.0 - 61.9	D-
78.0 - 79.9	C+	0.0 - 59.9	F

I may lower any of these requirements ***slightly*** at the end of the semester if it is appropriate. However, there is ***no guarantee*** of any such adjustment.

Individual Assignments

There are seven (7) assignments associated with selected chapters. These assignments are linked to chapter cases that will be used in class. There are also two assignments that are related to two RMA mini courses which are taken online at in RMA Ignite. The assignment due dates appear on the Do-List and Course Calendar on Canvas. **The five highest case assignment scores and the scores earned on the RMA mini courses will count towards the overall assignment grade for the semester.**

Chapter Quizzes

There are **nine (9) quizzes** that will be given on the dates specified in the course schedule. It will be a combination of conceptual questions and problem solving. The quizzes will be administered through Canvas. These will be proctored using Respondus Monitor. The comprehensive final is sponsored by the RMA through their testing website, as this exam is the Credit Essentials Certificate exam. This exam will be administered **face-to-face i**n a computer lab at UHCL. More information about the final will be distributed during the semester. An 80% in the final exam is required to earn the certificated from the RMA.

Group Project/Work

During the semester, you will be part of a group doing in-class exercises. The group will also work on in-class cases together. No outside group work is required. Attendance for the in-class group cases is mandatory, unless a documental excuse is provided.

Teams will have the opportunity to evaluate each member's contribution to group work being done. Colleague evaluations will be considered when determining each group member's grade. More details on the grading scheme will be provided during the semester.

ACADEMIC HONESTY

The Academic Honesty Policy at UHCL (found on the Dean of Students' website, the Faculty Handbook, the Student Handbook, the Senior Vice President and Provost's website, the Graduate Catalog, and the Undergraduate Catalog) states: Academic honesty is the cornerstone of the academic integrity of the university. It is the foundation upon which the student builds personal integrity and establishes a standard of personal behavior. Because honesty and integrity are such key factors in the professional community, you should be aware that failure to perform within the bounds of these ethical standards is sufficient grounds to receive a grade of "F" in this course and be recommended for suspension from UHCL. The Honesty Code of UHCL states ***"I will be honest in all my academic activities and will not tolerate dishonesty."***

You must complete the Academic Honesty Acknowledgement quiz in Canvas. The Academic Honesty Resources and Quiz are the first items in Canvas.

ACCESSIBILITY SUPPORT SERVICES

If you believe that you have a disability requiring an academic adjustment/auxiliary aid, please contact Disability Services by phone at 281-283-2648, e-mail

disability@uhcl.edu, or go to the office in the Student Services Building (SSCB), Room 1.302. The University of Houston System complies with Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 and the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, pertaining to the provision of reasonable academic adjustments/auxiliary aids for students with a disability. In accordance with Section 504 and ADA guidelines, the University of Houston-Clear Lake strives to provide reasonable academic adjustments/auxiliary aids to students who request and require them.

OTEHR INFORMATION YOU SHOULD KNOW

Recording of Class

Students may not record all or part of class, livestream all or part of class, or make/distribute screen captures, without advanced written consent of the instructor. If you have or think you may have a disability such that you need to record class-related activities, please contact the Accessibility Support Center. If you have an accommodation to record class-related activities, those recordings may not be shared with any other student, whether in this course or not, or with any other person or on any other platform. Classes may be recorded by the instructor. Students may use instructor's recordings for their own studying and notetaking. Instructor's recordings are not authorized to be shared with anyone without the instructor's written approval. Failure to comply with requirements regarding recordings will result in disciplinary referral to the Dean of Students Office and may result in disciplinary action.

Dropping and Withdrawing

University policy will be followed. Please consult the academic calendar at **https://www.uhcl.edu/academics/resources/academic-calendar/** for information regarding specific deadlines. The date is also stated in the course calendar.

Students who entered college for the first time in Fall 2007 or later should be aware of the course drop limitation imposed by the Texas Legislature. Dropping this or any other course between the first day of class and the census date for the semester/session does not affect your 6-drop rule count. Dropping a course between the census date and the last day to drop a class for the semester/session will count as one of your 6 permitted drops. You should consider this before dropping this or any other course. Visit **http://www.uhcl.edu/records** for more information on the 6-drop rule and the census date information for the semester/session.

Incomplete Grades

Grades of incomplete (I) will be given only in very unusual circumstances (e.g., major illness/accident requiring extended hospitalization) arising late in the semester that make it impossible for a student to finish the course. To be considered for an incomplete, you must have *already completed* most of the coursework with a passing grade. An "I" will not be given for situations that arise during the first half of the course; in such cases, the student should simply drop the class while (s)he still can do so. Incomplete grades also will not be given if the student's average is so low that the instructor believes (s)he is unlikely to pass with 60% or better. The student must notify the instructor of the circumstances necessitating an incomplete grade as soon as possible. No request for an "I" will be entertained after the end of the semester.

Weather-Related Class Cancellation

If severe weather should necessitate the closing of the campus, students should first call the Emergency Hotline at 281-283-2221 to determine whether classes will be held as scheduled. If the University is open, you may assume that class will meet, unless otherwise indicated by an announcement from the professor in Canvas or an e-mail from the professor.

Syllabus Changes

Due to unforeseen events, please note that the instructor may need to make modifications to the course syllabus and may do so at any time. Notice of such changes will be announced as quickly as possible through class announcement via Canvas and notifications sent to students' UHCL e-mail addresses.

Student Success Center

The Student Success Center is a comprehensive academic support resource for the UHCL student community. Services are free of charge and include tutoring for this course, study skill development, and academic coaching. Students can visit the Center's webpage at http://www.uhcl.edu/studentsuccesscenter or call 281-283-2450 to preview services and set appointments.

COLLEGE OF BUSINESS ASSESMENT STATEMEMT

The University of Houston-Clear Lake may use educational assessment tools in this course. "Educational Assessment" is defined as the systematic collection, interpretation, and use of information about student demographics, educational environments, learning outcomes, and professional success. These assessment tools will not affect student grades but will provide faculty with confidential detailed information that will be used to improve student learning, courses, curriculum, and program accreditation.

The College of Business may use assessment tools in this course and other courses for curriculum evaluation. This assessment will be related to the learning objectives for each course and individual student performance will be disaggregated relative to these objectives. This disaggregated analysis will not impact student grades but will provide faculty with detailed information that will be used to improve courses, curriculum, and student performance.